that “In these circumstances it is clear that the main element of any United States policy toward the Soviet Union must be that of a long-term, patient but firm and vigilant *containment* of Russian expansive tendencies”. His ideas became very popular soon after its publication in an article in the *Foreign Affairs* under the pseudonym ‘X’. This came to be known as the famous “X article”.[4]

Soon, situations in Greece and Turkey took such a turn that President Truman made Kennan’s assessment the keystone of the US foreign policy in the post-War years. The violence in Greece and Turkey was viewed by the Americans as inspired and instigated by the communists and, thus, Truman declared in March 1947, “I believe that it must be the policy of the United States to support the free peoples who are resisting attempted subjugation by armed minorities or by outside pressures”. This ultimately came to be identified as the **Truman Doctrine**. Thus, was born **the policy of containment** which aimed at preventing the expansion of the Soviet influence by encircling the Soviet Union and intimidating it with the threat of a military attack. Therefore, by late 1940s, the world witnessed the beginning of the formation of the two opposing blocs and it was reinforced by the **Marshall Plan** of 5 June 1947. Earlier on 5 March 1946, Churchill’s Fulton speech had signalled the beginning of the Cold War as he described in his speech that an Iron Curtain across Europe from Stettin in the Baltic to Trieste in the Adriatic had been drawn.[5] Only the Truman Doctrine and the Marshall Plan reaffirmed his contention and set an emerging new paradigm in the US foreign policy.